

How to Create and Set Up a Google Merchant Center Account (2026)

Blog (How-to guide) · 3000 words target (3000 allocated) · Aug 04, 2026, 10:40 AM UTC

PRIMARY KEYWORD	Google Merchant Center Account
SECONDARY KEYWORDS	how to create google merchant center account, google merchant center setup 2026, set up a google merchant center, google merchant account setup, merchant center account, google merchant account
TARGET AUDIENCE	Ecommerce merchants, digital marketing agencies, PPC managers
SEARCH INTENT	Transactional
TONE OF VOICE	Authoritative and expert
CTA	Soft CTA at the end to Simprosyst's Google Shopping Feed app

Intro

300 words

Open by framing why a Google Merchant Center account is the foundation for running Shopping ads and free listings in 2026 -- without it, products can't appear on Google Shopping. State plainly what the guide covers: a step-by-step setup walkthrough followed by the ongoing compliance guidelines every merchant must follow. Set the authoritative, expert tone immediately -- this is a definitive reference, not a beginner ramble.

Keywords: Google Merchant Center Account, google merchant center setup 2026

H2 Simple Steps for Setting Up Google Merchant Center

127 words

Brief overview stating the setup breaks down into seven straightforward steps, from account creation through final submission for review. Sets reader expectations before the numbered steps begin -- no need to repeat step details here, just the roadmap.

Keywords: set up a google merchant center

H3 Step 1: Create A Google Merchant Center Account

127 words

Go to merchants.google.com and sign in with an existing Google/Gmail account (or create one). Click 'Get started', accept the Merchant Center Terms of Service, and select the business's country and time zone -- note that country selection affects which policies and tax rules apply later.

Keywords: how to create google merchant center account

H3 Step 2: Adding Contact Information and Business Information

127 words

Enter business name, website URL, registered business address, phone number, and customer service contact details. Explain this data isn't just admin -- it can surface directly on Shopping ads and listings, so accuracy matters for trust and policy compliance.

Keywords: google merchant account setup

H3 Step 3: Need to verify your store website

127 words

Explain website claim and verification: Google requires proving ownership via an HTML tag, Google Analytics, Google Tag Manager, or Search Console before a domain can be used. Note why this exists -- it stops others from listing products under a domain they don't own.

Keywords: merchant center account

H3 **Step 4: Setting Up Shipping And Sales Tax**

127 words

Configure shipping settings (flat-rate or carrier-calculated) and delivery time estimates, plus sales tax settings where applicable (varies by country -- e.g. US merchants often set this manually, others rely on local tax-inclusive pricing). Flag that products can't go live until these are configured.

H4 **Ways to add products to Google Merchant Center:**

127 words

List the real methods merchants have: manual single-product entry, bulk upload via spreadsheet, scheduled fetch from a hosted feed URL, the Content API for large/dynamic catalogs, and platform integrations (e.g. a Shopify feed app) for automatic syncing. Note that most ecommerce sellers use a feed-based method rather than manual entry.

Keywords: google merchant account

H4 **Steps to add a primary feed:**

126 words

Walk through the concrete steps: go to Products > Feeds, click add feed, choose the destination (Shopping ads and/or free listings), select the input method (scheduled fetch, upload, or API), name the feed, and set the fetch schedule so product data stays current automatically.

H3 **Step 6: Review Google Policies**

126 words

Before submitting, review the Shopping ads and Merchant Center policies -- accurate product data, no prohibited content, working destination URLs. Frame this as the step that prevents an avoidable rejection or later suspension.

H3 **Step 7: Submit Your Merchant Centre for Review**

126 words

Once account, feed, shipping, and tax are all set, submit for Google's review. Note review can take a few days, account status is visible in the dashboard, and common rejection reasons (unverified site, policy violations, incomplete business info) are worth double-checking beforehand.

H2 **Follow the Guidelines of the Google Merchant Centre**

126 words

Short transition section: getting approved is only the start -- staying compliant is ongoing, and violations can suspend an otherwise-approved account. Sets up the specific guideline list that follows without repeating it.

Note: Keep this section short and distinct from the next H2 -- it's a transition, not the guideline list itself.

H2 **Google Merchant Center guidelines**

126 words

Proper introduction to the guideline list below: these are the ongoing rules Google expects merchants to maintain continuously, not one-time setup tasks. Briefly frame the eight guidelines that follow as the practical checklist for staying in good standing.

Note: This is the real intro to the 8 H3 guidelines below -- give it a distinct angle from the previous H2 so the two don't read as duplicated.

H3 **Follow Shopping Ads policies**

126 words

Adhere to Shopping ads policies specifically: accurate pricing and availability that match the landing page, working links, and meeting editorial/content requirements for product data.

H3 **Avoid prohibited practices**

126 words

Cover the common violations: misleading claims, counterfeit goods, clickbait product titles, and keyword stuffing in titles/descriptions. Note these are frequent, avoidable causes of suspension.

H3 **Don't sell restricted products (or follow restrictions)**

126 words

Explain that certain categories are banned or restricted (weapons, tobacco, counterfeit goods, certain health claims) and merchants should check Google's restricted products list before listing anything in a gray-area category.

H3 **Only promote products available for direct purchase**

126 words

Landing pages must let a user actually buy the exact item shown in the ad/listing -- no bait-and-switch, no listing out-of-stock items without correctly marking availability status.

H3 **Use a supported language consistently**

126 words

Product titles and descriptions must be in a language Google supports for the target country, and must stay consistent with the account's configured target country/language settings.

H3 **Collect user information securely**

126 words

Checkout and any data collection must run over HTTPS/SSL, with a clear privacy policy and secure payment processing -- Google checks for this as part of trustworthiness requirements.

H3 **Sign in regularly**

126 words

Google expects periodic account activity; extended inactivity can lead to an account being flagged or suspended automatically, so regular sign-ins matter even once everything is running smoothly.

H3 **Disclose AI-generated titles/descriptions**

126 words

Cover Google's evolving 2026 policy expectations around AI-generated product content -- if titles or descriptions are AI-generated, merchants should be prepared to disclose this per current guidance, since this is a newer and less widely known requirement worth calling out clearly.

Keywords: google merchant center setup 2026

H2 **Conclusion**

300 words

Recap that a correctly set-up Google Merchant Center Account plus ongoing guideline compliance is what unlocks sustained visibility on Google Shopping -- setup is a one-time task, compliance is continuous. Reinforce the authoritative tone by summarizing the stakes (suspension risk vs. steady performance).

Keywords: google merchant account

Note: Soft CTA here, not a hard sell: a natural closing mention pointing to Simpros's Google Shopping Feed app (e.g. linking to /google-shopping-feed) as a way to keep the feed accurate and compliant without manual upkeep.